

Hospitality and Tourism English Jargon Quick Reference

Field-specific terms, contrast pairs, and high-pressure sentence frames

Audience: hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals

Focus: A hospitality and tourism English curriculum for guest complaints, service recovery, reservations, revenue management, events, vendor coordination, cultural expectations, reviews, and operational briefings.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
check-in	In hospitality and tourism, check-in is a repeatable control mechanism used to prevent, detect, or confirm conditions before work proceeds. Use it when teams need to resolve arrival problems while protecting policy and guest dignity.	clarify check-in; document check-in	Contrast: check-in should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify check-in and the evidence that supports it.
room inventory	In hospitality and tourism, room inventory is an operational constraint that affects how much work can be completed, by whom, and by when. Use it when teams need to resolve arrival problems while protecting policy and guest dignity.	clarify room inventory; document room inventory	Contrast: room inventory should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify room inventory and the evidence that supports it.
upgrade	In hospitality and tourism, upgrade is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to resolve arrival problems while protecting policy and guest dignity.	clarify upgrade; document upgrade	Contrast: upgrade should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify upgrade and the evidence that supports it.
service recovery	In hospitality and tourism, service recovery is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to resolve arrival problems while protecting policy and guest dignity.	clarify service recovery; document service recovery	Contrast: service recovery should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify service recovery and the evidence that supports it.

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
guest complaint	In hospitality and tourism, guest complaint is a stakeholder category whose needs, eligibility, experience, or obligations affect the decision. Use it when teams need to respond to complaints without admitting unsupported facts.	clarify guest complaint; document guest complaint	Contrast: guest complaint should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify guest complaint and the evidence that supports it.
online review	In hospitality and tourism, online review is a structured examination of evidence, process, or results used to reach a defensible conclusion. Use it when teams need to respond to complaints without admitting unsupported facts.	conduct a online review; document the online review	Contrast: online review is a structured examination of evidence; it is not a conclusion reached before the evidence is checked. Example: The team will conduct a online review before it recommends a corrective action.
brand voice	In hospitality and tourism, brand voice is a communication or market-facing element that must match evidence, audience, channel, and approval boundaries. Use it when teams need to respond to complaints without admitting unsupported facts.	clarify brand voice; document brand voice	Contrast: brand voice should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify brand voice and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
compensation	In hospitality and tourism, compensation is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to respond to complaints without admitting unsupported facts.	clarify compensation; document compensation	Contrast: compensation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify compensation and the evidence that supports it.

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
overbooking	In hospitality and tourism, overbooking is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate inventory constraints transparently.	clarify overbooking; document overbooking	Contrast: overbooking should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify overbooking and the evidence that supports it.
walk	In hospitality and tourism, walk is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate inventory constraints transparently.	clarify walk; document walk	Contrast: walk should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify walk and the evidence that supports it.
occupancy	In hospitality and tourism, occupancy is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate inventory constraints transparently.	clarify occupancy; document occupancy	Contrast: occupancy should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify occupancy and the evidence that supports it.
rate parity	In hospitality and tourism, rate parity is a measurable indicator used to quantify performance, exposure, capacity, quality, or change over time. Use it when teams need to communicate inventory constraints transparently.	track rate parity; explain a change in rate parity	Contrast: rate parity measures a result or condition; it does not, by itself, prove the cause. Example: Before we act, let us track rate parity by segment and explain what changed.

Revenue Management and Pricing

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
ADR	In hospitality and tourism, ADR is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain pricing changes without sounding arbitrary.	clarify ADR; document ADR	Contrast: ADR should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify ADR and the evidence that supports it.
RevPAR	In hospitality and tourism, RevPAR is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain pricing changes without sounding arbitrary.	clarify RevPAR; document RevPAR	Contrast: RevPAR should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify RevPAR and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
yield management	In hospitality and tourism, yield management is a measurable indicator used to quantify performance, exposure, capacity, quality, or change over time. Use it when teams need to explain pricing changes without sounding arbitrary.	track yield management; explain a change in yield management	Contrast: yield management measures a result or condition; it does not, by itself, prove the cause. Example: Before we act, let us track yield management by segment and explain what changed.
compression night	In hospitality and tourism, compression night is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain pricing changes without sounding arbitrary.	clarify compression night; document compression night	Contrast: compression night should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify compression night and the evidence that supports it.

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
room status	In hospitality and tourism, room status is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to coordinate operational recovery across departments.	clarify room status; document room status	Contrast: room status should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify room status and the evidence that supports it.
out of order	In hospitality and tourism, out of order is a formal intake or routing mechanism that starts work, seeks a decision, or transfers responsibility. Use it when teams need to coordinate operational recovery across departments.	clarify out of order; document out of order	Contrast: out of order should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify out of order and the evidence that supports it.
turnover	In hospitality and tourism, turnover is a measurable indicator used to quantify performance, exposure, capacity, quality, or change over time. Use it when teams need to coordinate operational recovery across departments.	clarify turnover; document turnover	Contrast: turnover should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify turnover and the evidence that supports it.
preventive maintenance	In hospitality and tourism, preventive maintenance is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to coordinate operational recovery across departments.	clarify preventive maintenance; document preventive maintenance	Contrast: preventive maintenance should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify preventive maintenance and the evidence that supports it.

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
BEO	In hospitality and tourism, BEO is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to manage event details and last-minute changes.	clarify BEO; document BEO	Contrast: BEO should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify BEO and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
run of show	In hospitality and tourism, run of show is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to manage event details and last-minute changes.	clarify run of show; document run of show	Contrast: run of show should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify run of show and the evidence that supports it.
attrition	In hospitality and tourism, attrition is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to manage event details and last-minute changes.	clarify attrition; document attrition	Contrast: attrition should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify attrition and the evidence that supports it.
AV requirement	In hospitality and tourism, AV requirement is an approved rule or decision framework that sets what is permitted, required, or acceptable. Use it when teams need to manage event details and last-minute changes.	apply the AV requirement; comply with the AV requirement	Contrast: AV requirement is an approved rule or threshold, not an informal preference. Example: Please confirm which AV requirement applies before we commit the team.

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
itinerary	In hospitality and tourism, itinerary is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate itinerary changes and safety constraints.	clarify itinerary; document itinerary	Contrast: itinerary should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify itinerary and the evidence that supports it.
force majeure	In hospitality and tourism, force majeure is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate itinerary changes and safety constraints.	clarify force majeure; document force majeure	Contrast: force majeure should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify force majeure and the evidence that supports it.
waiver	In hospitality and tourism, waiver is a negotiated legal or commercial arrangement that allocates rights, obligations, remedies, or risk. Use it when teams need to communicate itinerary changes and safety constraints.	clarify waiver; document waiver	Contrast: waiver should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify waiver and the evidence that supports it.
local operator	In hospitality and tourism, local operator is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to communicate itinerary changes and safety constraints.	clarify local operator; document local operator	Contrast: local operator should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify local operator and the evidence that supports it.

Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
service standard	In hospitality and tourism, service standard is an approved rule or decision framework that sets what is permitted, required, or acceptable. Use it when teams need to interpret guest behavior across cultures without stereotyping.	apply the service standard; comply with the service standard	Contrast: service standard is an approved rule or threshold, not an informal preference. Example: Please confirm which service standard applies before we commit the team.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
cultural expectation	In hospitality and tourism, cultural expectation is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to interpret guest behavior across cultures without stereotyping.	clarify cultural expectation; document cultural expectation	Contrast: cultural expectation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify cultural expectation and the evidence that supports it.
guest profile	In hospitality and tourism, guest profile is a stakeholder category whose needs, eligibility, experience, or obligations affect the decision. Use it when teams need to interpret guest behavior across cultures without stereotyping.	clarify guest profile; document guest profile	Contrast: guest profile should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify guest profile and the evidence that supports it.
recovery gesture	In hospitality and tourism, recovery gesture is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to interpret guest behavior across cultures without stereotyping.	clarify recovery gesture; document recovery gesture	Contrast: recovery gesture should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify recovery gesture and the evidence that supports it.

Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

Situation	Useful language
Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation	Before we commit, I want to confirm check-in, room inventory, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If inventory, loyalty status, housekeeping, policy, and guest emotion need balance., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Complaint Handling and Online Reviews	Before we commit, I want to confirm guest complaint, online review, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If investigation, privacy, brand tone, and recovery options must be considered., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks	Before we commit, I want to confirm overbooking, walk, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If walk policy, partner hotel, transportation, compensation, and empathy are needed., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Revenue Management and Pricing	Before we commit, I want to confirm ADR, RevPAR, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If demand, compression nights, contract terms, and value need careful explanation., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover	Before we commit, I want to confirm room status, out of order, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If room status, staffing, maintenance defects, and guest promises need coordination., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Events, Banquets, and Run of Show	Before we commit, I want to confirm BEO, run of show, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If contract, staffing, setup time, safety, and vendor capacity need review., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Tour Operations and Traveler Safety	Before we commit, I want to confirm itinerary, force majeure, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If safety, local rules, refunds, timing, and guest expectations must be managed., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Cultural Expectations and Service Style	Before we commit, I want to confirm service standard, cultural expectation, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If expectations, language, nonverbal cues, and service standards need coaching., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.

High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.

- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

Contrast Pairs

Do not confuse	Useful distinction
check-in vs service recovery	In guest arrival and front-desk escalation, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
guest complaint vs compensation	In complaint handling and online reviews, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
overbooking vs rate parity	In reservations, overbooking, and walks, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
ADR vs compression night	In revenue management and pricing, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
room status vs preventive maintenance	In housekeeping, maintenance, and turnover, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
BEO vs AV requirement	In events, banquets, and run of show, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
itinerary vs local operator	In tour operations and traveler safety, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
service standard vs recovery gesture	In cultural expectations and service style, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.